

# Asset Management

MBA 233

Fall 2026

Instructor: Sam Olesky  
Email: olesky@haas.berkeley.edu  
Office Hours: by appointment  
Office Location: F502N

Class Hours: Tuesdays and Thursdays 2:00 – 3:30  
Class Location: Cheit Hall, C220

## Privacy and Recording Notice

**Course Description:** The course will cover a broad range of investments and structuring investment portfolios. We will consider investments, security selection and investment portfolios from the perspective of individual and institutional investors. The course is designed to develop investing knowledge empirically and through academic theory.

**Required books:** A Random Walk Down Wall Street, Burton G. Malkiel, 2023 edition, W. W. Norton & Company, Inc. (RW)

Unconventional Success, David F. Swensen, 2005, Free Press (US)

**Grading:** Contribution to class discussion will account for 25% of the grade. The midterm project will comprise 25% of the grade and the final project will account for 30%. Assignments, collectively, will account for 10% of the course grade. Your Questions, collectively, will account for 10% of the course grade. More than three absences will adversely affect the class contribution grade.

| <u>Date</u>  | <u>Topic</u>                                   | <u>Reading(s) / Speaker</u>                   |
|--------------|------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| August 27    | Course overview & Investments exercise         |                                               |
| September 1  | Risk and Return<br>Manias, Bubbles & Crashes   | US chapter 1 and RW chapters 1, 2, 13         |
| September 3  | U.S. Equities                                  | US pages 33-48 and RW chapters 3, 4           |
| September 8  | Foreign Equities                               | US pages 57-66                                |
| September 10 | Treasury Bonds, TIPS, & Agencies               | US pages 48-57                                |
| September 15 | Corporate & Municipal Bonds<br>Bonds – Speaker | US pages 92-122<br>Dustin Seely – Dodge & Cox |
| September 17 | Real Estate                                    | US pages 66-80                                |
| September 22 | REITs mini-presentations                       |                                               |

|                    |                                                      |                                                             |
|--------------------|------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| September 24       | Venture Capital & Private Equity                     | US pages 133-147                                            |
| September 29       | Hedge Funds                                          | US pages 125-133                                            |
| October 1          | Venture Capital - Speaker                            | David Hartwig – 359 Capital                                 |
| October 6          | Hedge Funds – Speaker                                | David Kim – Farallon Capital                                |
| October 8          | Midterm project work session                         |                                                             |
| October 13         | Technical Analysis                                   | RW chapters 5, 6                                            |
| October 15         | Fundamental Analysis                                 | RW chapters 7, 13, pages 281-285                            |
| October 20         | Rational Models                                      | RW 8, 9                                                     |
| October 22         | Mutual Funds &<br>Exchange Traded Funds (ETFs)       | US chapter 11 and RW pages 377-389                          |
| October 27         | ETFs – speaker                                       | Bart Sikora - BlackRock iShares                             |
| October 29         | Mutual Funds,<br>Fundamental Equities                | Carl Kawaja – Capital Group                                 |
| November 3         | Behavioral Models<br>Behavioral mini-presentations   | RW 10                                                       |
| November 5         | AI and Machine Learning for<br>Investments – Speaker | Art Amador – Quantum Street AI                              |
| November 10        | Active and Passive Management                        | US pages 203-207<br>and US chapters 7, 8, 10                |
| November 12        | Smart Beta / Factor Investing                        | RW pages 258-273                                            |
| November 17        | Portfolio Construction                               | US chapter 3 and RW pages 347-370                           |
| November 19        | Rebalancing &<br>Volatility Harvesting               | US chapter 6                                                |
| <b>November 24</b> | <b>No class - Thanksgiving</b>                       |                                                             |
| <b>November 26</b> | <b>No class - Thanksgiving</b>                       |                                                             |
| December 1         | Investment Consulting -                              | Ali Ware & Ijeh Ogbechie -<br>Speakers Cambridge Associates |
| December 3         | Final project work session                           |                                                             |

| Inclusive                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Supportive                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Prompt & Present                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Learning-Focused Tech                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| I value the diverse experiences and perspectives of my peers and myself.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | I support my peers and myself through challenges to become better business leaders.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | I show up to class ready to learn because I value the learning experience.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | I utilize paper or a lay-flat tablet for notes to minimize distractions and stay engaged.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>Respectful:</b> I listen to and respect those with different viewpoints than me.<br><br><b>Professional:</b> I step back when I have shared my voice more than my classmates to make space for others to be heard.<br><br><b>Engaged:</b> I step up and contribute when my voice or viewpoint has not been shared. | <b>Respectful:</b> I stay patient, helpful, and curious when my peers need extra support.<br><br><b>Professional:</b> I practice leadership and allyship by encouraging others to step out of their comfort zone in class.<br><br><b>Engaged:</b> I ask for clarification when I need it, knowing that others may have similar questions. | <b>Respectful:</b> I arrive on time so class can begin without disruptions.*<br><br><b>Professional:</b> I plan ahead to only leave during breaks so my peers and professors can stay focused.<br><br><b>Engaged:</b> I attend class so I can learn from and contribute to class discussions.<br><br><small>*Occasional late arrivals and absences should be the exception rather than the norm</small> | <b>Respectful:</b> I keep my laptop and phone away to respect professors and speakers.**<br><br><b>Professional:</b> I lay my paper or tablet notes flat to help other students stay focused on their learning.<br><br><b>Engaged:</b> I recognize that my engagement contributes to a positive learning environment.<br><br><small>**Laptops and phones may be used for instructor-approved purposes and disability accommodations.</small> |

Academic Norms | Full-time MBA Program

BerkeleyHaas

**The student community at UC Berkeley has adopted the following Honor Code:**

“As a member of the UC Berkeley community, I act with honesty, integrity, and respect for others.” The hope and expectation is that you will adhere to this code.

**Collaboration and Independence:** Reviewing lecture and reading materials and studying for exams can be enjoyable and enriching things to do with fellow students. This is recommended. However, unless otherwise instructed, homework assignments are to be completed independently and materials submitted as homework should be the result of one’s own independent work.

**Cheating:** A good lifetime strategy is always to act in such a way that no one would ever imagine that you would even consider cheating. Anyone caught cheating on a quiz or exam in this course will receive a failing grade in the course and will also be reported to the University Center for Student Conduct. In order to guarantee that you are not suspected of cheating, please keep your eyes on your own materials and do not converse with others during the quizzes and exams.

**Plagiarism:** To copy text or ideas from another source without appropriate reference is plagiarism and will result in a failing grade for your assignment and usually further disciplinary action. For additional information on plagiarism and how to avoid it, see, for example: <http://gsi.berkeley.edu/teachingguide/misconduct/prevent-plag.html>

**Academic Integrity and Ethics:** Cheating on exams and plagiarism are two common examples of dishonest, unethical behavior. Honesty and integrity are of great importance in all facets of life. They help to build a sense of self-confidence, and are key to building trust within relationships, whether personal or professional. There is no tolerance for dishonesty in the academic world, for it undermines what we are dedicated to doing – furthering knowledge for the benefit of humanity.

Your experience as a student at UC Berkeley is hopefully fueled by passion for learning and replete with fulfilling activities. And we also appreciate that being a student may be stressful.

There may be times when there is temptation to engage in some kind of cheating in order to improve a grade or otherwise advance your career. This could be as blatant as having someone else sit for you in an exam, or submitting a written assignment that has been copied from another source. And it could be as subtle as glancing at a fellow student's exam when you are unsure of an answer to a question and are looking for some confirmation. One might do any of these things and potentially not get caught. However, if you cheat, no matter how much you may have learned in this class, you have failed to learn perhaps the most important lesson of all.